

Murder Mystery

Dinner Party 2026



Anne E. Dote

The Meridian Museum

October 30, 2026 / Private player packet / 1 of 12

INTRODUCTIONS

Anne E. Dote

Director of Education & Docent Programs

Anne can make a school group care about a pot shard. Tonight's donors are proving harder.

- Often rescues **Reed DeLabel** from awkward public-facing moments.
- Works with **Claire O'Scuro** to translate scholarship into gallery interpretation.

ACTING TIPS

Engaging, practical, empathetic, irreverent about institutional pomp.

YOUR INTRODUCTION / READ THE BOX ALOUD

I'm Anne E. Dote. I run education here. I can make almost anything interesting, including a room full of adults behaving badly.

Continue to your private briefing on page 3. Keep the packet facing you.

INTRODUCTIONS

Anne E. Dote

Behind the portrait

Your grievance with Grant

Grant's gift conditions would cut public education programming to fund a private donor lounge and VIP entrance.

Your other secret

You organized an anonymous staff petition against the plan and slipped copies into trustee folders.

Conversations to start

- Ask Anya Tique whether she will defend the education program against a donor lounge.
- Ask Claire O'Scuro what ordinary visitors would lose if education funding disappeared.

If a named guest is absent, speak to someone else. Your printed account may conceal another scandal, even if you are innocent. Stick to it during the hearings; save corrections for Coming Clean.

Memorize your animal and return the slip. When the host announces the selected animal, use IF MURDERER if it matches yours; otherwise use IF INNOCENT. Never read an IF heading aloud.



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.**

HUNT FOR CLUES

Anne E. Dote

The museum has misplaced its paperwork. Naturally.

Sixteen numbered envelopes are hidden around the house. These three hints lead to three different hiding places. Leave the furniture and household objects where they are. Bring an envelope to the Evidence Table; read and share the discovery inside.

- 1 *The artwork is innocent; something behind it deserves questioning.*
- 2 *A Bible contains a small addition that is not part of scripture.*
- 3 *The mirror has a secret that never appears in its reflection. Look above the glass.*

Already found? Read that discovery at the Evidence Table, then try another hint. Ask for help reaching a hiding place; nobody needs to climb. You may investigate together.



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
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ACT I: MOTIVE

Anne E. Dote

Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 6, then choose the next guest. The host tracks turns.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Tess Tament

What did Grant's financial plans threaten to take from you?

Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Sue Venir

What did Grant pressure you to approve or overlook?

Hugh Bidder / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid

What did Grant demand over a sale or purchase?

Dada DiCapo / Vincent Van Faux / Drew Conclusions

How did Grant threaten your work or reputation?

Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel / Justin Tyme

What unwelcome research did Grant want suppressed?

Barb Dwyer / Paige Turner / Faye Stop

What did Grant ask you to hide, and why?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Al Baster / Minnie Malist

What last-minute demand put your work at risk?

Mona Lott / Elle Loominate / Robin Banks

What dispute made you want Grant's announcement stopped?

Anya Tique / Ella Gance / Penny Pincher

What past decision was Grant threatening to expose?

Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates / Anne E. Dote

How did Grant's decisions threaten your livelihood or work?

Your speaking box is on page 6. Turn only within this act.

ACT I: MOTIVE

Anne E. Dote

Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you.
After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

EVERYONE / READ ALOUD

The children were not invited to negotiate the budget. Grant's gift conditions would cut school tours and community education to pay for a private donor lounge and VIP entrance. The children would get less museum so his friends could get more privacy. I wanted those conditions taken out.

You can ask someone to repeat a detail. Discuss your suspicions after everyone has answered.



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
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ACT II: OPPORTUNITY

Anne E. Dote

Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 8, then choose the next guest. The host tracks turns.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Tess Tament

Where were you before the toast, and why?

Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Sue Venir

What were you checking in the exhibition, and when?

Hugh Bidder / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid

What occupied you before Grant's private toast?

Dada DiCapo / Vincent Van Faux / Drew Conclusions

Where did your work take you before the toast?

Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel / Justin Tyme

What were you examining before the unveiling, and when?

Barb Dwyer / Paige Turner / Faye Stop

What did you observe while the toast was prepared?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Al Baster / Minnie Malist

What last-minute work were you doing, and where?

Mona Lott / Elle Loominate / Robin Banks

Where did you go before the toast, and why?

Anya Tique / Ella Gance / Penny Pincher

What drew you to the exhibition before the toast?

Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates / Anne E. Dote

What were you arranging before Grant drank?

Your speaking box is on page 8. Turn only within this act.

ACT II: OPPORTUNITY

Anne E. Dote

Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you.
After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

I copied the school-tour wording inside the alcove at 6:34 by my phone. At 6:44 I was at the gallery entrance sorting trustee folders. Schoolchildren would have asked much better questions than the trustees were asking.

IF MURDERER

At about 6:43 by my phone, I went inside the Star Bowl alcove to copy the wording inside the cabinet after sliding the front pane aside. Children ask excellent questions about very bad labels. I took my school-tour proposal to the salon for Grant.

You can ask someone to repeat a detail. Discuss your suspicions after everyone has answered.



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
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ACT III: METHOD

Anne E. Dote

Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 10, then choose the next guest. The host tracks turns.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Tess Tament

What did you handle or conceal during setup?

Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Sue Venir

What materials or records passed through your hands?

Hugh Bidder / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid

What did you borrow, conceal or change tonight?

Dada DiCapo / Vincent Van Faux / Drew Conclusions

What did you alter that could look suspicious?

Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel / Justin Tyme

What did you discover or conceal in your work?

Barb Dwyer / Paige Turner / Faye Stop

Which objects or records need your explanation?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Al Baster / Minnie Malist

What changed during setup, and what did you do?

Mona Lott / Elle Loominate / Robin Banks

What might someone misinterpret about your preparations?

Anya Tique / Ella Gance / Penny Pincher

What part of your past or preparation needs explaining?

Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates / Anne E. Dote

What passed through your hands that matters tonight?

Your speaking box is on page 10. Turn only within this act.

ACT III: METHOD

Anne E. Dote

Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you.
After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

EVERYONE / READ ALOUD

I organized the anonymous staff petition and slipped copies into trustee folders. Grant's donor lounge would have cost the children their tours. My secret campaign was paperwork. It was quite capable of ruining his announcement without anybody ruining his ability to attend it.

Evidence Table / discovery index

- | | |
|----------------------------------|-----------------------------------|
| 1. Gift agreement | 9. Education reallocation |
| 2. Shipping manifest / 1988 | 10. Donor Salon camera |
| 3. A warning left behind | 11. Donation entry / 1989 |
| 4. GRANT'S NIGHT OF GLORY | 12. Closing reveal / concept |
| 5. Treatment finding | 13. Display proposal / superseded |
| 6. Donor agreement / margin copy | 14. Clock inspection slip |
| 7. Auction result | 15. Cancelled programme cue |
| 8. Vincent Van Faux | 16. Grant Larceny's toast |



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
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ACCUSATIONS

Anne E. Dote

Your ballot

Choose one attending guest. Explain your accusation in your own words. Fold this loose page writing inward and give only the ballot to the host. Keep your packet for Coming Clean. Votes lock when all ballots are collected.

Your character name

I accuse

Why? Motive, evidence and any unresolved contradiction

Best Actor

Best Costume



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
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COMING CLEAN

Anne E. Dote

The last word

Read only when the host calls you. Top three suspects read first. If none confesses, the host calls the selected animal to stand. Use your own role's box; keep every other word private.

IF INNOCENT / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I organized the anonymous staff petition against the education cuts. My account of the evening was true. My late task was outside the sealed display alcove. Any inspection I made inside it was earlier, before the emergency closure. My concealed business explains the suspicion around me. I did not poison Grant, and I will answer for my own secret without accepting his murder.

IF MURDERER / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

The children were not invited to negotiate the budget. Grant's gift conditions would cut school tours and community education to pay for a private donor lounge and VIP entrance. The children would get less museum so his friends could get more privacy. I wanted those conditions taken out. I stole the toxin and wiped it inside Grant's empty coupe with museum linen before the cordial was poured. I invented a late alcove visit from the old programme and enclosed-cabinet drawing. I had missed both the early closure and the open-cradle installation. Others lied about their times to hide scandals; my claimed work never happened at all. I was at Grant's glass instead. I acted alone. I poisoned Grant Larceny.

Every selected suspect gets their final word.